

Store — taking real money

The store works end to end **except** the last step. Adding, removing, quantities, the subtotal and persistence all function; Checkout currently shows you what *would* be sent instead of charging anyone.

Everything below is about flipping that last switch.

The one thing that matters

Your Square access token must never appear in store.js. Anything in that file is public — anyone can read it. A leaked token lets someone issue refunds from your account.

That single constraint is what decides which mode you can use.

Choose a mode

Open store.js. Near the bottom:

```
var CHECKOUT = {
  mode: "demo",           // "demo" | "link" | "api"
  currency: "USD",
  links: { "pin-gameboy": "", "key-digivice": "", "plate-custom": "" },
  endpoint: "/api/checkout"
};
```

Mode	Backend needed	Multi-item cart	Good for
demo	none	—	what ships now
link	none	X one item at a time	start here
api	yes, small	✓	when one-at-a-time starts costing you sales

Mode "link" — no server, works today

Square calls these **Payment Links**. Each is a hosted checkout page for one product, and the URL is safe to publish.

1. Square Dashboard → **Online** → **Payment Links** → **Create**
2. Choose *Accept a payment* (or *Sell an item* to attach the photo and stock).
3. Set the name and price so they **match this page exactly** — the customer will compare, and a mismatch reads as a scam.
4. Turn on **Collect shipping address** if you're posting it.
5. Copy the `https://square.link/u/xxxxxxx` URL.
6. Paste it against the matching data-id:

```
mode: "link",
links: {
  "pin-gameboy": "https://square.link/u/AbCdEfGh",
  "key-digivice": "https://square.link/u/IjKlMnOp",
  "plate-custom": "https://square.link/u/QrStUvWx"
}
```

The cart still works for browsing; at checkout it redirects to that product's Square page. If more than one line is in the cart it says so rather than charging the wrong amount.

The limitation is real. Someone buying three pins pays three times, in three transactions, with three shipping fees. That is the moment to move to api.

Mode "api" — a real cart

Needs one server endpoint. Netlify Functions, Vercel, Cloudflare Workers — all have free tiers that comfortably cover a maker store.

It receives { lines, currency } and returns { url }:

```
// netlify/functions/checkout.js
const { randomUUID } = require("crypto");

// PRICES LIVE HERE, NOT IN THE BROWSER. Never trust a price the client sends -
// anyone can edit data-price in devtools and buy a $30 plate for $0.01.
const PRICES = {
  "pin-gameboy": { name: "Game Boy Pin", cents: 1800 },
  "key-digivice": { name: "Digivice Keychain", cents: 2200 },
  "plate-custom": { name: "Custom Art Plate", cents: 3000 }
};

exports.handler = async (event) => {
  const { lines } = JSON.parse(event.body);

  const order = {
    idempotency_key: randomUUID(),
    order: {
      location_id: process.env.SQUARE_LOCATION_ID,
      line_items: lines.map(l => {
        const p = PRICES[l.id];
        if (!p) throw new Error("unknown product " + l.id);
        return {
          name: p.name,
          quantity: String(Math.max(1, Math.min(99, l.qty | 0))),
          base_price_money: { amount: p.cents, currency: "USD" }
        };
      })
    },
    checkout_options: {
      redirect_url: "https://pnova.com/store?paid=1",
      ask_for_shipping_address: true
    }
  };

  const res = await fetch(
    "https://connect.squareup.com/v2/online-checkout/payment-links", {
    method: "POST",
    headers: {
      "Square-Version": "2025-01-23",
      "Authorization": `Bearer ${process.env.SQUARE_ACCESS_TOKEN}`,
      "Content-Type": "application/json"
    },
    body: JSON.stringify(order)
  });

  const data = await res.json();
  if (!res.ok) return { statusCode: 502, body: JSON.stringify(data) };

  return { statusCode: 200, body: JSON.stringify({ url: data.payment_link.url }) };
};
```

Then set mode: "api". Test against Square's **sandbox** credentials first — they issue a separate token and card numbers that never move money.

Read that PRICES comment twice. The single most common way small stores get robbed is trusting the price the browser sends. The server must look up its own prices from the product id and ignore whatever arrived.

Before you list anything real

Legally required in most places - A refund/returns policy, and shipping times, on the page or linked from it. - Sales tax. Square can calculate and collect it — turn it on per location. - A real contact address on the site.

You will regret skipping these - **Stock.** Nothing here knows what's sold out. Until it does, either mark items sold out by hand or let Square's inventory do it (in link mode, Square hides a sold-out link for you). - **Shipping cost.** Currently £0/\$0. Set it in Square per item or per order. - **Order notifications.** Square emails you, but set it up deliberately rather than finding out three days later. - **A sold-out state on the card.** The design has one already — reuse the CLAIMED treatment from Drops: ash, struck through.

Worth doing early - **Variants** (size, colourway). Neither the cart nor data-id handles these. The cheapest fix is one data-id per variant. - **Real photos.** The placeholders are obviously placeholders and will kill trust faster than anything else on this list. - **og: tags** so a link to the store previews with the logo instead of nothing. Currently missing sitewide.

If Square turns out to be the wrong fit

The cart is deliberately payment-agnostic — `cartLines()` and `total()` are all any provider needs.

- **Stripe Payment Links** — same shape as Square's, often simpler dashboard.
- **Shopify Buy Button** — heaviest, but inventory/tax/shipping all solved.
- **Gumroad / Etsy** — they take a cut and own the customer relationship, but you list an item and you're selling the same afternoon.

Swapping means rewriting one function, `checkout()`. Nothing else in the store knows or cares who takes the money.